Cell Phone Usage

Policy and Procedure Statement

The purpose of this policy is to outline the appropriate use of personal cell phones during the course of Foundation business. There is reference to provincial legislation. Foundations need to edit the text to refer to restrictions in their respective legislation. The text below was written for a Foundation in Alberta, and based on your location, this may need adjustments. As you're crafting the policy, answer the following question for each paragraph: Does this align with our culture and practices, and if not, what changes do we need to make?

This policy applies to all Foundation personnel and applies to any device that makes or receives phone calls, leaves messages, sends text messages, surfs the Internet, or downloads and allows for the reading of and responding to email whether the device is Foundation-supplied or personally owned.

In compliance with (insert reference to your provincial Highway Traffic Act) the Foundation prohibits its employees from the following activities for business purposes related in any way to the organization, while driving.

- the use of hand-held cell phones, texting or e-mailing, using electronic devices like laptop computers, video games, cameras, video entertainment displays and programming portable audio players (e.g.: MP3 players), entering information on GPS units, reading printed materials in the vehicle, writing, printing or sketching, and, personal grooming (ensure that this text aligns with provincial regulations)

This prohibition of cell phone or similar device use while driving includes receiving or placing calls, text messaging, surfing the Internet, receiving or responding to email, checking for phone messages, or any other purpose related to one's employment; the business; customers; vendors; volunteer activities, meetings, or civic responsibilities performed for or attended in the name of the Foundation; or any other Foundation related activities not named here while driving.

It is recognized that other distractions occur during driving, however the use of cell phones, while driving, is strictly prohibited by the Foundation. Therefore, employees are required to stop their vehicle in a safe location so that they can safely use a cell phone or similar device.

The Foundation is aware that employees utilize their personal cellular phones for business purposes. At the same time, cell phones are a distraction in the workplace. To ensure the effectiveness of meetings, and as a professional courtesy to others, employees are asked to leave cell phones at their desk. Or, on the unusual occasion of an emergency or anticipated emergency that requires immediate attention, the cell phone may be carried to the meeting on vibrate mode.

Insurance for Employee or Volunteer Use of Own Auto

Most foundations are not in a position to own or lease vehicles, which means employees are using their own vehicles for foundation business. The purpose of this policy is to outline the employee's and the Foundation's insurance coverage when an employee uses their own vehicle for Foundation business. In this instance the Foundation's insurance coverage must include non-owned auto. The policy also applies to volunteers using their automobile on Foundation business. The Foundation's non-owned auto coverage limit needs to be substituted for the limits in the policy below. The Foundation also needs to get confirmation from their employee or volunteer that they are suitably insured.

Policy and Procedure Statement

When an employee or volunteer is using a personal vehicle while on Foundation business, their personal auto insurance is the primary insurer. The Foundation's limit for non-owned automobiles is $2 million. This is paid in excess of the underlying automobile insurance for the owner of said vehicle.

For example, if the employee has an underlying liability limit of $1 million (as is typical) and uses a personal vehicle for Foundation purposes and a claim is substantiated in the amount of $2.5 million, the owner's automobile policy would pick up the first $1 million and the Foundation's insurance would pick up the additional $1.5 million.

Contact with media

Media relations are important for the Foundation as this gets your name out in the public consciousness and informs the community of your Foundation's impact, your programs, mission, and identity. Having a media relations policy helps to mitigate reputational risk.

The Foundation needs to determine who has the authority to speak on behalf of the Foundation to the media, under different scenarios. Amend the policy below to fit your Foundation's practice.

Policy and Procedure Statement

The purpose of this policy is to outline the protocol for Foundation contact with the media and applies to all Foundation personnel.

The Chair of the Board of the Foundation is the official spokesperson on governance and policy issues. The ED/CEO and the Chair of the Board speak on major announcements. The ED/CEO is the spokesperson on operational issues. The ED/CEO is the media contact. Should other employees be contacted by the media for comment, they are to refer the media to the ED/CEO who will respond and/or refer appropriately.

SECTION 4

Compensation

Salaries, Wages & Benefits

An effective compensation policy defines how the Foundation views and manages employee pay and benefits. The policy should motivate current employees and attract new employees. The policy in this template can be used as the basis for your Foundation's compensation policy and can be amended accordingly by asking the following question after each section: does this segment align with our Foundation's standards and practices.

The Foundation is committed to a policy of salary administration which is internally and externally competitive and equitable and also recognizes and encourages individual performance. The purpose of the policy is to:

- Ensure the fair and equitable salary treatment of the Foundation employees
- Set salary levels which will enable the Foundation to recruit and retain qualified employees
- Provide guidelines for ongoing salary administration
- Promote individual performance
- Encourage innovation and creative solutions
- Fulfill the organizational mission, vision and promote strategic direction
- Produce job satisfaction

Salary Schedule: The salary schedule will be based on the established salary that will be reviewed annually by the ED/CEO.

Full-Time & Part-Time Employees: Salary, benefits and vacation will be confirmed at time of employment and reviewed annually.

ED/CEO: Salary, benefits and vacation will be as negotiated through an employment contract and reviewed annually.

Some Foundations provide additional benefits to their employees, such as group insurance, RRSPs or parking. Participating in existing group medical coverage is more cost effective. The local Chamber of Commerce has such coverage. Many provinces have similar group programs for non-profit organizations. Below are some sample clauses for benefits.

Group Insurance Benefits: note: if your foundation provides group insurance, enter the parameters into this paragraph, including who pays the premium and when the group insurance starts for new employees.

One component of the Group Insurance plan is an Employee Assistance Program which provides up to 12 hours of face to face counseling per year, per employee.

If the Foundation is still enrolled with the Chamber of Commerce Group Insurance Plan, upon retirement, executive staff, who have been enrolled in the plan for 2 years and who have been employed for 5 years, are eligible to enroll in the Health and Dental benefit program for retiring Chambers of Commerce Insurance Plan for owners and principals. The premiums for this plan are the responsibility of the retiring executive.

RRSP: Upon successful completion of the probationary period, full-time and part-time employees are entitled to receive a 4% contribution per pay period towards a self-directed RRSP. There is also an opportunity for employees to contribute to the same self-directed RRSP.

Parking: Upon successful completion of the probationary period, full-time employees are entitled to have their parking paid for by the Foundation. Part-time employees are entitled to receive $40 per month towards parking or bus pass (upon submission of receipts).

Vacation

Employees need a break from work every now and then in order to maintain their physical and mental health. A number of studies have shown that taking time away from the job can have physical and psychological health benefits. People who take vacation have lower stress, less risk of heart disease, a better outlook on life, and more motivation to achieve goals. Taking vacations also provides employees the opportunity to get more sleep, which leads to better brain function and improved performance upon their return.

Foundations have a couple of options with respect to developing a vacation policy: pay vacation pay, or provide vacation time. Below are policy statements reflecting both options. Foundations need to determine costs and benefits for each as they relate to their circumstances.

Policy and Procedure Statement (paying vacation pay)

All employees at the Foundation will earn vacation pay on all wages earned from the first day of employment.

After being employed for twelve months, an employee will receive an annual vacation. After completing twelve months of employment, an employee will have earned ten working days of annual vacation.. This means that starting in the second year, an employee must take the vacation earned in the year before.

Employees shall be required to submit a completed “Leave Form” for vacation time.

No vacation pay/time will be given in advance.

Vacation will be granted on a combination of seniority, availability, and job coverage.

Although every effort is made by the Foundation to satisfy an employee's choice of vacation time, legislation confirms the Foundation is able to request an employee to take time vacation when the Foundation so chooses.

Full-time Employees – The Foundation will provide vacation pay to employees. The Foundation will pay vacation at four percent for the first 4 years inclusive and this then becomes 6% to full-time employees in their fifth year. When vacation time is taken the accrued vacation dollars will be paid to the employee.

It is understood all employees are required to take a minimum two (2) weeks of vacation time each per year. Each employee will take scheduled vacation time off per the following:

- After completing one full year of service — ten working days
- Five to ten years continuous service — fifteen working days
- More than ten years of service — twenty working days

Policy and Procedure Statement (earning vacation days)

Full-time Employees – The Foundation pays vacation time to full-time employees. Vacation should be taken in full during the employment year. Cash payments will not be made in lieu of vacation except upon termination of employment.

Vacation Schedule

- After completing one full year of service — 2 weeks
- 5 – 10 years continuous service — 3 weeks (after completion of the 5th year)
- more than 10 years of service — 4 weeks (after completion of the 10th year)

Part-time Employees – Part-time employees will accumulate one day per month in lieu of payment of 4% vacation pay. The day is equivalent to the normal number of hours regularly worked by the employee.

It is understood all part-time employees are required to take a minimum two (2) weeks of vacation time, either paid or unpaid, during the vacation period in accordance with the Employment Standards Act (ensure that this clause aligns with your provincial legislation).

If the accumulated vacation credit is not used by the employee's anniversary date, then it will be paid out to the employee.

Professional Development

Employees are your Foundation's most important asset. Their training and development is something in which your Foundation should invest. By training employees and investing in their career development you can make them feel valued by the Foundation. Offering professional development training programs and opportunities allows employees to perform better and prepares them for positions of greater responsibility. But it can also help employers attract top job candidates, retain their best workers and identify future leaders.

Policy and Procedure Statement

The Foundation values professional development for its employees and will budget annually for such opportunities.

From time to time employees will be requested to take up-grading courses or other courses related to their position. The Foundation shall pay flights and accommodations (if required), as well as tuition costs for these courses. The Foundation shall pay for a regular day of work only, travel time is not paid. Employees will be responsible for all meals and incidentals. All courses must have prior written approval from the ED/CEO.

Leave of Absence

Leave of absence policies are meant to provide employees with work-life balance and, in certain circumstances, to give employees needed time away from work in urgent and compelling circumstances. Your provinces' Employment Standards Act prescribes specific instances when leave must be granted. Appendix A provides links to provincial ESAs.

Policy and Procedure Statement

It is the policy of the Foundation to comply with the Employment Standards Code, and the Foundation reserves the right to change its policy without notice if there is a change in such law. Due to the complexities of family and medical leaves, it is important to contact the ED/CEO regarding specific leave requirement requests.

Requests for leave are accepted for the following periods of unpaid leave:

Emergency Leave: An employee may receive up to ten days of leave to attend to family emergencies. This leave will be unpaid, but will not affect seniority, benefits or the employee's position. This leave will comply with the Employment Standards Act. The ten days do not have to be taken consecutively. The employee must inform their employer as soon as possible if they will need to take any of these days off. The employer has the right to ask for proof of the emergency.

Personal Leave: A personal leave may be granted on a limited basis depending on business needs. This leave will be unpaid. This leave complies with the Employment Standards Code. If an intermittent or reduced leave is

requested on this basis, the Foundation may require the employee to temporarily transfer to an alternative position with equivalent pay and benefits which better accommodate the intermittent or leave schedule.

Medical/Disability Leave: An employee may be granted a medical leave because of a serious health condition or non-work-related injury due to an accident. This leave complies with the Employment Standards Code. As a condition of the employee returning from a leave because of the employee's own serious health condition, the Foundation may require medical certification from his/her health care provider that the employee is able to resume work. This leave may be paid or unpaid according to the short-term disability policy provisions for the Foundation.

Pregnancy/Parental Leave: As per the Employment Standards Code.

Parental Leave for Birth and Adopting Parents: As per the Employment Standards Code.

Family Responsibility Leave: As per the Employment Standards Code.

Bereavement Leave: As per the Employment Standards Code.

Compassionate Care Leave: As per the Employment Standards Code.

Bereavement Leave: As per the Employment Standards Code.

Jury Duty: As per the Employment Standards Code.

Reservists' Leave: As per the Employment Standards Code.

Sick Leave

Sick days reduce turnover. Studies have shown that companies that offer paid sick leave see a reduction in employee turnover somewhere between 3.61% to 6.43%. Low turnover maintains consistent productivity, boosts employee engagement and morale, and builds a sense of unity between staff and managers. Foundations are encouraged to include this policy within their document as it provides clarity for handling employee absence due to illness. The following policy can form the basis of one developed for your Foundation.

Policy and Procedure Statement

This policy applies to bona fide non-occupational illnesses and injuries. The accumulation of sick leave time allows continuation of full base pay plus benefits when an eligible employee is required to be absent from work because of non-occupational illnesses, injuries or medical conditions.

Sick leave is accrued based on a staff member's regularly scheduled hours of work. A full-time employee accrues sick leave at the rate of ten days each calendar year. A regular part time employee accrues sick leave on a pro-rata basis. Sick leave may not be carried over into a subsequent calendar year and it cannot be cashed out as it has no intrinsic cash value. Sick leave balances are not earned compensation nor are they payable at termination of employment. Sick leave is paid on a straight time basis not to exceed the scheduled hours for the scheduled work hours missed.

Sick leave will not accrue for any period during which an employee is absent from work for more than ten workdays, except for absence due to holidays, vacation and personal days and approved Employment Standard Act leaves. When an eligible employee will be off on Sick leave, he/she must notify his/her supervisor as soon as he/she knows that he/she will be unable to work, but no later than the starting time of the employee's work day. Employees must notify their supervisor on each day of absence unless other arrangements have been made.

When an eligible salaried employee has been out on sick leave for more than three (3) consecutive scheduled work days, he/she is required to submit documentation from a health care provider to their supervisor certifying the medical necessity for the absence and expected date of return to work. Sick leave may be used for illness of the eligible employee or for illness of a member of his/her household (up to three (3) days per calendar year). Sick leave is provided for the reasons stated in this policy and may not be used for other purposes. Sick leave pay may not be advanced.

In cases of illness, which is expected to continue beyond sick leave accrual, the Short-Term Disability Benefit (if applicable) and/or Family or Personal Leave provisions of applicable provincial legislation will apply. Regular full-time employees earn sick leave from the first full payroll period worked. Paid sick leave may not be taken in advance of accrual. However, employees are allowed 10 'personal emergency leave' days under the Employment Standards Act. These may be taken at any time once an employee begins work (i.e. regardless of probationary period). However, they do not need to be paid.

Sick Leave must be recorded as such on payroll time sheets so that accurate records can be maintained. All information about an employee's medical condition is confidential and must be kept by the ED/CEO in a file separate from the employee's personnel file. When an employee is absent for medical reasons, the employee's regular personnel file will contain only the dates of the medical absence, not the medical reason(s) for the absence.

The Foundation reserves the right to have an employee visit an alternate physician, participate in an Independent Medical Examination (IME) or to make other appropriate investigations in cases of protracted illness or frequent absences.

Time Off For Medical Appointments

Employees are requested to make appointments at times that will minimize time away from work. Conditions of taking time off will be at the discretion of the supervisor.

SECTION 5

Health and Safety

Health and Safety

Canadian health and safety legislation requires employers to have a health and safety program in their workplace. A written policy helps to promote an effect program. Such policy should reflect the special needs of the workplace and should be regularly reviewed and updated.

Foundation's should refer to their provincial Occupational Health and Safety regulations when developing this policy, links to which can be found in Appendix A.

Policy and Procedure Statement

The Foundation acknowledges it has a duty under the current Occupational Health & Safety Legislation (insert appropriate name of provincial legislation) and Federal Labour Standards to take all reasonable precautions to protect all persons working on site, (employee, volunteers, board members, donors) and all visitors.

Fire exits are located throughout the premises. For everyone's own safety, all persons should be familiar with the locations of these exits and the most efficient route to exit in case of fire.

The Foundation will maintain all Statutory Health and Safety practices and implement such others as are consistent with the needs and position as a charitable organization. All persons when on site are required to refrain from any activity which may jeopardize the health and safety of others.

Employee, Volunteer and Contractors' Rights

There are three basic rights for employees, volunteers and contractors under the joint responsibility health and safety model:

- The right to know about workplace safety hazards,
- The right to refuse unsafe work if they have "reasonable cause to believe the work is dangerous",
- The right to participate in the occupational health and safety process.

Employee, Volunteer and Contractors' Obligations

Maintaining a safe work environment requires the continuous cooperation of all employees, volunteers and contractors.

- They must recognize that it is their duty to comply with all Health and Safety rules, regulations and guidelines.

- They are required to refrain from any unsafe practices or hazardous actions and to exercise due care and diligence.
- Any unsafe conditions, materials or equipment and all accidents or injuries must be reported to the ED/CEO.

Fitness for Duty

This policy refers to the use of drugs and alcohol while on duty. There may be instances where this is permitted. Given the legalization of cannabis, the clarity of this policy is critical. The policy below provides direction on when, and when not, such use is acceptable. FOundations need to reflect on each of the statements to ensure that they comply with their values, principles and practices that are acceptable in their community.

Policy and Procedure Statement

All Foundation employees are required to:

A. Come to work fit for duty

B. Take reasonable care to protect the health and safety of themselves and others at all times

C. Refrain from being impaired by alcohol, marijuana and any other drugs while on duty

D. Notify their supervisor if they suspect that a co-worker is unfit for duty

E. Consume intoxicants in a responsible manner at all times when at Foundation events and other functions where employees represent the Foundation.

The Foundation will help and encourage employees who recognize a problem by referring them to treatment facilities. Employees who would like additional information regarding this matter should contact the ED/CEO. All such inquiries will be treated with the utmost confidence.

Use of Illegal drugs:

- The use, sale, purchase or possession of illegal drugs while on the job or Foundation property is strictly prohibited.
- Employees may not report to work under the influence of illegal drugs.
- Employees are required to immediately notify the ED/CEO of any suspected instance of use, possession, or knowledge of someone under the influence of such substances on Foundation property.

In addition, any employees of the Foundation convicted of any drug-related crime must notify the ED/CEO within five days of any such conviction.

Use of Alcohol:

The Foundation does not provide funds for the purchase of alcohol at Foundation sponsored activities. However, employees may consume alcohol if they so choose under the following guidelines:

A. Employees are expected to make travel arrangements at functions where they are representing the Foundation and at which they are consuming alcohol, such as: assign a designated driver, take alternate transportation, arrange to stay in a hotel

B. An employee may be asked to stop consuming alcohol if it is believed they are exhibiting inappropriate behaviour.

Any employee found to be in violation of the preceding paragraph will be subject to disciplinary action which may include termination of employment.

SECTION 6

Hiring

Hiring Process

Being open and clear with candidates helps to set proper expectations, avoid disappointments, and shape a positive candidate experience. By being transparent, your Foundation will not only have an easier time recruiting top talent, you will also have higher rates of retention because expectations have been clear from the beginning. Given that the Foundation benefits the community, it is important in the hiring practices, to ensure that the workplace reflects their community and to authentically grow a commitment to gender equity as an organization.

This policy provides guidelines that will help to mitigate risk in all aspects of the hiring process. Use this as a guideline when developing your Foundation's process and amend to fit your practices.

Policy and Procedure Statement

The success of the Foundation in attempting to achieve its vision depends on having the right employees, properly trained and motivated, applying their skills and talents to all assigned responsibilities outlined in job descriptions.

The Foundation will follow consistent hiring guidelines in order to maximize the chances for success in fulfilling its mission by hiring the most qualified and competent applicants for all employment vacancies. The Foundation adheres to PIPEDA rules relating to employee information.

Procedures:

1. To be eligible for employment with Foundation, applicants must:
    - meet the stated requirements for the position being sought,
    - be willing to work in accordance with the Foundation's vision, goals, objectives, policies and procedures, and
    - be legally entitled to work in Canada.
2. The Foundation is an equal opportunity employer and adheres to the (appropriate provincial Human Rights Act).
3. The recruitment, selection and hiring process will be fair and consistent.
4. Throughout the recruitment, selection and hiring process, applications and applicants' information will remain confidential.

Recruitment

A good recruitment process is very important for your Foundation, but in more ways than you may think. The process itself speaks volumes about your company. It is a direct reflection of the validity and professionalism of your organization. Not only do your prospective employees as well as current employees use this as a standard of measure for your Foundation, your donuts, customers and the community do as well. This policy provides guidelines that will help to mitigate risk in the recruitment process. The policy and procedures below outline a recommended practice. Amend to fit your Foundation's practices.

Policy and Procedure Statement

The Foundation will endeavour to recruit the most competent individuals to fill all positions.

Procedure:

1. Approval to recruit for vacant or newly created positions will be granted by the (insert appropriate level of authority for your Foundation).
2. Job advertisements shall include the following information:
    - Job Title
    - Essential requirements for education and experience
    - Knowledge and skills required
    - Salary range
    - Starting/ending date where applicable
    - Hours of work
    - Closing date of competition
    - Respondent

Selection

Going through a systematic set of questions and even skills tests will determine if candidates are able to fulfill the job needs. This helps establish confidence in knowing that you have logically gone through a recruiting process and choose people based on defined metrics rather than gut feelings. When you do this, you increase your chances of having someone succeed in the job. If you don't need to constantly replace people, you will save time and money on the recruiting and training of new candidates. Understand that downtime could negatively affect your Foundation's revenues if you become short-staffed; keeping turnover low is important. There are costs and time spent putting out job ads, interviews and training new people. Taking the time to choose properly the first time helps mitigate this. Use this policy and procedures below as guidelines when developing your Foundation's selection process. Amend to fit your Foundation's practices.

Policy and Procedure Statement

The Foundation will conduct a selection process that is fair and equitable.

Procedures:

1. It is the responsibility of each applicant to demonstrate that he/she meets the requirements of the position.
2. For support employees positions the appropriate supervisor receives and reviews all applications; those that meet the requirements will be contacted for interviews. The supervisor will conduct interviews. There may be instances where a second individual participates in the interview. This individual will be determined by the supervisor in consultation with the ED/CEO.
3. In the event that a new ED/CEO must be hired, the applications will be received and reviewed by the Board of Directors or the Board Hiring Committee. For this position, the Board of Directors will choose a Hiring Committee that consists of a minimum of three persons. (note: this clause should be discussed by the full board and amended accordingly).
4. A short list of applicants that meet the basic requirements will be invited to an interview.
5. Second interviews will be held when several candidates demonstrate equal abilities.
6. Once a final candidate has been determined a verbal offer of employment can be made, except if the position being filled is that of the ED/CEO, in which case the Board of Directors must give approval. Following receipt of approval to hire, a verbal offer can be made to the candidate. IT should be noted that a verbal offer is legally binding on the Foundation.

Written Offer of Employment

A job offer letter allows the employer to itemize the facts about the offer, outline the job's responsibilities and highlight relevant details about the company. In the event that the candidate requests to negotiate issues like salary or vacation, the job offer letter serves as the critical reference point. A clearly written offer of employment is also a risk mitigant. The policy and procedures below outline a recommended practice. Amend to fit your Foundation's practices.

Policy and Procedure Statement

All employees shall receive an employment package outlining the conditions of employment.

Procedures:

1. Once a verbal offer has been made and a verbal offer of acceptance has been received, a written offer of employment is prepared that includes:
    - Position Title
    - Job Description
    - Salary & Benefits
    - Vacation Entitlement
    - Starting Date
    - Hours of work
    - Probationary period of _____ months
    - Statement that candidate will uphold the bylaws of the foundation
    - Specific conditions that may apply
2. Two copies of the offer of employment will be made. The potential employee will be requested to sign one and will be given the other for their personal records.
3. Upon receipt of written acceptance from the applicant, the Foundation will respond in writing to all unsuccessful applicants who were interviewed.
4. The employment package will include a copy of the Human Resources Policy and Procedure Handbook, Code of Ethics and Confidentiality policies, travel expense claim and the appropriate overtime tracking document.

The employee will sign a confirmation that the employee has read and understood the employee package.

Orientation

Orientation is important because it provides the new employee with concise and accurate information to make him/her more comfortable in the job, encourages employee confidence and helps the new employee adapt faster to the job, contributes to a more effective, productive workforce, improves employee retention; and promotes communication between the supervisor and the new employee. An effective orientation program is also a risk mitigant. The policy and procedure below is one example of a program. Amend to fit your Foundation's practices.

Policy and Procedure Statement

The Foundation recognizes the importance of providing essential information to newly hired employees. All new employees will be provided with an orientation session during the first week of employment with the Foundation. Contract employees will be provided with the necessary information to carry out the responsibilities of their contract.

Procedure:

1. The immediate supervisor will conduct the orientation, except if the new employee is the ED/CEO. In this situation the Chair of the Board of Directors or his/her designate will conduct the orientation.
2. Brief the new employee on the role, purpose, vision and mission of the Foundation. Provide the employee with copies of recent annual reports, newsletters and other supporting documents that help to define the mandate of the Foundation.
3. Review relevant policy and procedure manuals, including the Human Resource's Policies and Procedures. Have them sign that they have read and understood these policies.
4. Have the employee read and sign the Confidentiality Agreement, file the signed copy in the employees file. Give a duplicate copy of the agreement to the employee for their records.
5. Inform the new employee of expected responsibilities and review the job description.
6. Inform the new employee of the probationary performance evaluation.
7. Inform the employee about pay administration.
8. Answer any questions as required.

Probationary Review

No matter how robust the recruitment process, it is all too easy to employ someone who underperforms or simply doesn't fit the organization. Having a probationary period gives you the opportunity to assess suitability for a role. You could find, a few weeks or months into the relationship, that the employee isn't able to deliver the performance or doesn't have the skills promised at interview, has poor attendance or timekeeping or just doesn't fit in terms of company culture or personality. Having a probationary period is also a risk mitigant. The policy and procedure below is one example of a program. Amend to fit your Foundations's practices.

Policy and Procedure Statement

All employees have a six-month probationary period. A three-month evaluation of all new employees will be conducted followed by a probationary review that will be conducted at the end of the sixth month of employment.

Procedure:

1. The employee's immediate supervisor will complete the probationary review and shall inform the employee in writing, not less than two weeks prior to the end of the probationary period, the date of the review.
2. If the ED/CEO is the new employee, an elected representative(s) from the Board of Directors will complete the review and shall inform the ED/CEO in writing, not less than two weeks prior to the end of the probationary period, the date of the review.
3. The immediate supervisor or Board of Directors shall complete the performance appraisal and inform the employee in writing of the successful completion of the probationary period. A copy of the performance appraisal and the letter are placed in the employees personnel file.
4. If it is not possible to determine if the employee is suitable for ongoing employment, the probationary period may be extended for up to six months. The employee shall be notified in writing that the probationary period has been extended for a specific time period.